

Submission Responses

Application Form

Organization Name

Harmony for Hope, Inc.

Website (If Applicable)

<https://www.harmonyforhopewv.org/>

Contact Name

Carrie A Kidd

Title

President / Executive Director

Phone Number

+1 304-877-7688

Email

ckidd@harmonyforhopewv.org

Physical Address

704 Main Street, Mount Hope WV, 25880

Is there a different Mailing Address?

Yes

Mailing Address

706 Main Street, Mount Hope, WV 25880

Is your organization an IRS Designated 501(c)(3) or equivalent entity?

Yes

What is your organizations Tax ID/EIN?

811907024

Date your organization was formed

2017-03-28

Organization's History and Mission

Organization's History and Mission

Harmony for Hope, Inc. is a West Virginia 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization based in **Mount Hope, Fayette County, in the New River Gorge region**. The organization was created to strengthen West Virginia communities by connecting **music, art, Appalachian heritage, education, community service, and technology** in ways that build local pride, participation, opportunity, and quality of life.

Harmony for Hope has a long history of community-based work in Mount Hope and southern West Virginia. Its projects have included arts and cultural programming, youth and family activities, historic preservation and interpretation, community events, volunteer service, and place-based community development. Past work includes public art projects, the Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail, heritage interpretation, community cleanups and service activities, holiday and cultural events, and development of the Fayette County Community Arts Center as a community resource.

The organization has also worked to connect local history and physical places with digital tools and public information so that residents and visitors can better understand and engage with West Virginia communities. More recent program development expands this work through community leadership, digital stewardship, heritage education, and responsible use of technology.

Harmony for Hope's mission is to **bring West Virginians together through music, art, Appalachian heritage, education, and technology while strengthening the communities and places that give West Virginia its identity**. The organization focuses on practical, locally grounded projects that help residents participate in their communities, preserve local assets, develop useful skills, and create stronger opportunities for future generations.

Its current work remains rooted in Mount Hope and Fayette County while developing models that may, when appropriate, be adapted to other communities across West Virginia.

Description of Current Programs and Activities

Harmony for Hope, Inc. currently provides community, cultural, educational, heritage, and volunteer programming in **Fayette and Mercer counties**, with its primary place-based work centered in Mount Hope and the New River Gorge region.

Current programs and activities include the **Mount Hope Regional Band**, which creates opportunities for musicians of different ages and experience levels to participate in community music and public performances; the **Oakvale Area Outreach Team in Mercer County**, which supports locally identified community needs through volunteer service, outreach, and community-based activities; and Harmony's Kids, which supports youth participation in arts, educational, and community activities.

Harmony for Hope also continues work connected to the **Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail**, including local history, heritage interpretation, visitor information, and community engagement. Through the **Fayette County Community Arts Center**, the organization continues long-term development of a community space intended to support arts, culture, education, heritage, and local programming as facility conditions and resources allow.

Additional activities include Appalachian arts and heritage promotion, community events, volunteer service, public art and cultural projects, and development of new place-based leadership and educational opportunities. Harmony for Hope is currently developing the **West Virginia Community Champion Leadership Cohort Series**, beginning with a proposed six-month pilot in Mount Hope, Fayette County, to provide free practical training in community leadership, heritage

stewardship, local resources, information literacy, accessibility, privacy, and responsible community participation.

Across its programs, Harmony for Hope focuses on creating practical ways for West Virginians to **learn, participate, volunteer, preserve local culture, build useful skills, and strengthen the communities where they live.**

Description of Formal and Informal Relationships with Other Organizations or Foundations

Harmony for Hope, Inc. maintains a network of formal and informal relationships supporting its community-development, heritage, education, technology, and grant-readiness work in Fayette County and the New River Gorge region.

Harmony for Hope has a **signed client agreement with WV Hive, a program of the New River Gorge Regional Development Authority**, providing an entrepreneurial and regional-development support pathway. The organization has also received written letters of support from the **City of Mount Hope; Town of Thurmond; New River Gorge National Park and Preserve; West Virginia University; and Starry Eyes Media**. These letters reflect support or interest within the scope stated by each organization and are not represented as funding commitments or approvals beyond their written terms.

Harmony for Hope also has a formal related-party professional services relationship with Carrie Ann Kidd d/b/a Kidd's Technical Services (KTS). Under a written Master Services Agreement and related Statements of Work, KTS may provide technical, geospatial, systems, documentation, infrastructure, grant-implementation, and strategic support for approved H4H projects. Because KTS is owned by Harmony for Hope's founder, related-party transactions are subject to documented conflict-of-interest, board review, and recusal requirements where applicable.

Harmony for Hope also maintains working or advisory relationships with the **West Virginia Grant Resource Centers at West Virginia University, Region 4 Planning and Development Council, the West Virginia Community Development Hub, Beckley Area Foundation, Marshall University, and West Virginia University**. These relationships include grant guidance, regional planning input, technical assistance, project review, higher-education outreach, and community-development support, but are not represented as formal institutional commitments unless separately documented.

Harmony for Hope distinguishes among formal agreements, letters of support, technical assistance, referrals, advisory relationships, and informal collaboration so that no organization's role or commitment is overstated.

Paid Full Time Employees

0

Paid Part Time Employees

0

Volunteers/Other

15

Expenses (Previous Full Fiscal Year)

\$254.40

Revenues (Previous Full Fiscal Year)

\$600.00

Is this for a Pledge or Multi-Year Request?

Only organizations who have applied annually and been funded for at least two consecutive years will be considered for this.

No

Amount Requested (Total Amount for Single Year or All Multi-Year Funds)

\$10,000.00

Summarize the Purpose of Your Request

Be specific to the amount and what the funding will be used for exactly.

Harmony for Hope, Inc. requests **\$10,000** to implement a **six-month Mount Hope Community Champion Leadership Pilot in Fayette County, West Virginia**. The project will provide approximately **one free, four-hour Community Champion training each month for six months**, serving 10–15 participants per session, or approximately 60–90 participant training seats during the grant period.

Grant funds will be used specifically for **\$1,800 in program coordination and administration; \$1,000 for curriculum refinement and reusable training materials; \$1,800 for facilitator preparation and delivery of six training sessions; \$900 for accessible meeting space; \$900 for participant workbooks, printing, maps, and supplies; \$900 for participant transportation and travel-access assistance; \$500 for accessibility supports; \$300 for Historic Walking Trail and field-learning supplies; \$600 for evaluation, documentation, and program improvement; \$500 for insurance and compliance expenses; and \$800 in contingency for reasonable implementation cost changes. Total request: \$10,000.**

Training will use **Mount Hope and the Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail as a practical learning environment** and will focus on community leadership and stewardship, local-resource awareness, Appalachian heritage, information literacy, privacy and responsible information practices, accessibility, community engagement, and structured reporting. Participation will be offered **without tuition**, with grant support helping reduce transportation and accessibility barriers.

The six-session format will allow Harmony for Hope to **deliver, evaluate, improve, and repeat the training model**, creating a documented foundation for future Community Champion cohorts in

West Virginia.

List the County or Counties in West Virginia ONLY Being Served by this Request

The money must stay in West Virginia but can be used for any or all of the 55 counties.

Fayette, Raleigh, Mercer, and Nicholas Counties.

Timeframe to Use Grant Funds - Start Date

2027-01-01

Timeframe to Use Grant Funds- End Date

The funds will need to be used by this deadline and an End of Funding Report submitted.

2027-12-31

Program or Project Title for the Request

Mount Hope Community Champion Leadership Pilot

Total Program or Project Budget Amount for the Request

\$10,000.00

How will you measure success?

Harmony for Hope will measure success through **participation, training completion, demonstrated skills, participant feedback, accessibility, and program improvement.**

During the six-month pilot, H4H plans to provide **six free Community Champion training sessions**, with approximately 10–15 participants per session, or 60–90 participant training seats. We will track registrations, attendance, training completion, repeat participation, counties represented, and completion of supervised exercises.

Participants will complete practical activities involving local resources, heritage, information verification, privacy and authority boundaries, accessibility, and structured reporting. H4H will document whether participants can identify reliable sources, distinguish observation from verified information, recognize when an issue belongs to another organization or public authority, and report information responsibly.

Participant feedback will be collected after training to identify what was useful, what was unclear, barriers to participation, transportation or accessibility needs, and areas where the curriculum should be improved. H4H will also track program costs, venue needs, facilitator time, and other lessons needed to determine whether the model can be repeated.

Success will not be measured by attendance alone. The pilot will be successful if H4H can demonstrate that participants learned practical community-stewardship skills and if the six-month experience produces a tested, improved, and documented Community Champion training model that can support future cohorts in West Virginia.

How will you sustain the project or program?

Harmony for Hope is designing the Community Champion program to remain **low-cost, repeatable, and locally supported after the initial grant period**. Grant funding will pay for much of the one-time work needed to refine the curriculum, create reusable participant materials, establish training procedures, test accessibility and field exercises, and document what works. Those materials can then be reused and improved for future cohorts, reducing the cost of subsequent training.

H4H will sustain the program through a combination of **volunteer leadership, existing organizational programs and community assets, partner support, future grants and sponsorships, and shared use of training materials and local resources**. Future cohorts may be offered at a smaller scale or less frequently depending on available resources rather than requiring the same \$10,000 investment each year.

Over the longer term, the Community Champion program is also being developed as part of the **MountainShares community-governance and participation model**. As MountainShares moves from development into responsible operation, it may provide additional infrastructure and program-support mechanisms for Community Champion participation. H4H does not expect that system to fully finance the program during this initial grant period, and continued Community Champion training will not depend on MountainShares becoming revenue-producing on a specific timetable.

The goal of the six-month pilot is therefore to use grant funding to **build the reusable foundation of the program**, learn its actual operating costs, and develop a model that H4H can continue and expand as resources become available.

Official IRS Determination Letter

See attached files

Cover Letter

This can be addressed to the Board of Directors.

See attached files

Current Board List

See attached files

Organizations Operating Budget (Previous Full Fiscal Year)

See attached files

Program or Project Budget Request and Quotes

This budget is specific to the request. Quotes can be provided for bricks/mortar, construction items, etc. pertaining to the request.

See attached files

Photos

Harmony for Hope, Inc. - 2026 - Application Form

Photos of the organization, events, bricks and mortar needs, etc. Please make sure you have permission to submit any photos of children, clients, or individuals you work with.

See attached files